The Fourth Sheet

Example report · Not-for-profits

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

What does it cost to raise a dollar?

Period: August 2026. What fundraising costs (grant writing, donor campaigns, events) for every dollar it brings in. Pick a source and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

August 2026 Locked August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Each dollar raised cost 13¢ in August, and 12¢ a dollar this financial year to date.

Source: All fundraising

August · all fundraising
13¢
July 11¢

Year to date (Jul to Aug 2026)
12¢
same period last year: 12¢

Cost to raise a dollar, by source, August 2026 (cents)



What it shows
August cost 13¢ to raise each dollar, against 11¢ in July. This financial year to date it has cost 12¢ a dollar, against 12¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
The year-to-date figure is steadier than single months: events make some months jump. Pick a source above to see which one moves it.

Source: Grants

August · Grants
10¢
July 10¢

Year to date (Jul to Aug 2026)
10¢
same period last year: 12¢

What it shows
Grants cost 10¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($14,200 of grant writing and reporting for $146,318), against 12¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Usually the cheapest money to raise, as long as the time that goes into applications and acquittals is protected.

Source: Donations

August · Donations
12¢
July 15¢

Year to date (Jul to Aug 2026)
13¢
same period last year: 15¢

What it shows
Donations cost 13¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($4,400 of donor campaigns for $32,700), against 15¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Steady and cheap, and untied: the money that builds reserves.

Source: Fundraising events

August · Fundraising events

—

July none raised

Year to date (Jul to Aug 2026)

—

same period last year: –

What it shows

Fundraising events cost – to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($2,400 of event costs for $0).

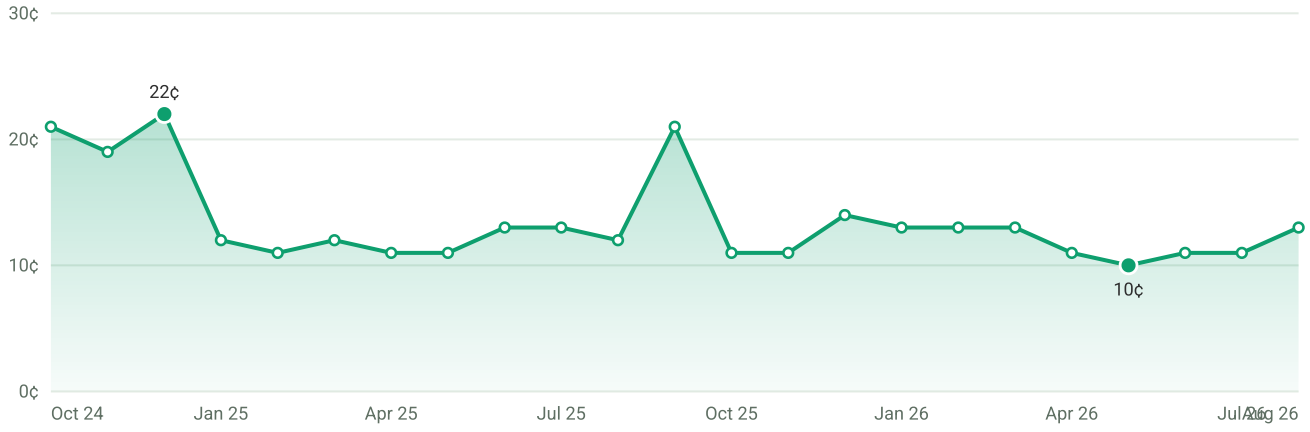
What you'd do about it

Usually the dearest money to raise: events are worth counting for what else they bring too (new donors, profile).

Every source at once

Cost to raise a dollar, by month (cents)

All · Cents per $1



Months with an event (the gala, the Christmas appeal) jump. A gap means nothing was raised that month. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.